

IELTS Writing Best Practices – Revision Sheet

1. Start with a Strong Introduction

Weak: Writing is important in life.

Strong: Writing is often regarded as a means of communication; however, it also plays a vital role in shaping and refining human thought.

Template: [Paraphrase the topic]; however, [your main idea/opinion].

2. Clearly State Your Opinion (Thesis)

Weak: I think writing is good.

Strong: This essay argues that writing is an essential tool for developing clear and structured thinking.

3. Use Clear Paragraph Structure

Each paragraph should focus on one main idea.

Example: One key reason why writing is important is that it helps individuals organize their thoughts effectively.

4. Use Linking Words (Cohesion)

Firstly / Secondly / Finally

In addition / Furthermore

As a result / Therefore

In contrast / However

Example: Furthermore, writing encourages deeper reflection and critical analysis.

5. Use Formal Vocabulary

a lot → many / numerous

get better → improve / enhance

help → assist / enable

Example: Writing enhances cognitive ability and improves language proficiency.

6. Use Complex Sentences

Use structures such as: Although / While / Because / As

Example: Although writing may seem simple, it involves complex cognitive processes.

7. Avoid Repetition

Weak: Writing is important because writing helps people and writing improves skills.

Better: Writing is important because it helps individuals develop skills and express ideas more effectively.

8. Support Your Ideas

Always explain your point clearly.

Example: Writing helps organize thoughts because it forces individuals to present their ideas in a clear and logical manner.

9. End with a Strong Conclusion

Weak: In conclusion, writing is good.

Strong: In conclusion, writing is not only a method of communication but also a powerful tool for developing clear and structured thinking.

10. Keep Your Tone Academic

Avoid: I think / I feel (basic), slang or casual language

Use: It is widely believed that... / Writing is considered essential...

Useful Sentences to Memorize

Introduction: It is widely acknowledged that writing plays a crucial role in both communication and thinking.

Body: One of the main advantages of writing is that it enhances clarity and organization of ideas.

Body: In addition, writing allows individuals to reflect more deeply on complex topics.

Conclusion: In conclusion, writing is an indispensable skill that contributes significantly to both personal and professional development.

Final Tip

Think first, then write. Good writing = clear thinking + strong structure + effective vocabulary.